

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Don't believe the hype! You should always check your online sources.



Learning Outcome

Explain about technology and technical problems in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Are there websites that post fake news in your country? What kind of articles do they publish?
- Do you always check for the reliability of the information you read online? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can talk about future actions.





Let's Explore!

Sally tells her how to **sift through*** all the information they find online.

* To "*sift through*" means to examine something closely to keep what you really need.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The vast amount of data found on the Internet doesn't mean that everything you read is up-to-date. Old literary texts or philosophical works aren't going to change much in the future, so the posting date may not be relevant. However, if you are doing research on current topics you will find websites that are simply out-of-date.

If relevance is important to your research, you must make sure that you check both the date of publication and the date of the last revision. Technology is in a constant state of flux, and you won't have enough information on just one website. For this reason, you should always cross-check your sources. We expect the new generation of browsers to do that for us from the next year onwards.

You could also test a website's usability by looking at how many times users refer to it for credible information. You will find that a few sites get most of the traffic because they are the most reputable in their field.

So, the next time you're doing research online, you might want to start by browsing the site and checking whether it's user-friendly. You wouldn't want to waste your time on useless info!



Let's Practice!

Sally shares her thoughts on the future of the Internet.

Instructions: Unscramble the words to find the mystery sentence.

1. texts / Old / aren't / . / going / the / much / in / to / literary / future change

2. on / you / date / topics / If / out / doing / . / current / of / are / research / will / that / find / , / are / websites / you

3. from / the / to / select / . / information / new / expect / year / We / the / for / generation / next / browsers / onwards / us / right / of

4. because / that / a / their / they / few / find / . / the / field / most / You / reputable / most / sites / traffic / of / will / in / are / get / the



Let's Practice!

Sally is passionate about new technologies. Are you as eloquent* as she is?

* When you are "eloquent", you are able to speak well and at length about a subject.

Instruction: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes.

1. The vast amount of data find on the Internet don't mean that everything you read is up-to-date.
2. However, if you are do research on current topics, you will finding websites that are simply out of date.
3. Technology are in a constant state of flux, and you won't has enough information on just one website.
4. We expects the new generation of browsers to do that for we from next year onwards.
5. You wouldn't want or waste your time on useless info!





Extension Activity

Write a fake technology news article.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and browse articles on the website for *The Onion*. This website publishes funny articles that look like real news articles, but they are written for entertainment and humor.
- Write an article (10-14 lines) in the style of *The Onion*. Write news that is funny and not true.
- Think of a situation that could sound real, but isn't.
- Include some elements of technology in the article.
- Read your article to your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify news articles online.

☐ ☐

I write about technology.

☐ ☐

I offer suggestions for the future.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- up-to-date** (adjective): containing the latest information
e.g. Not everything you read online is up-to-date.
- out-of-date** (expression): no longer valid or relevant
e.g. You will find websites that are simply out-of-date.
- flux** (noun): a state of constant change
e.g. Technology is in a constant state of flux.
- to cross-check** (verb): to verify information by checking it against alternative sources
e.g. You should always cross-check your sources.
- usability** (noun): the state of something being easy to use
e.g. You could also test a website's usability by looking at how many times users visit it.
- credible** (adjective): able to be believed; convincing
e.g. Reliable websites offer credible information.
- user-friendly** (adjective): easy to use
e.g. You might want to check that the website is user-friendly.
- to browse** (verb): to look through webpages on the Internet
e.g. You might want to start by browsing the site and checking whether it's user-friendly.



Learning Points

Discussing How to Deal With Problems

One way to discuss how to deal with problems is to say what you would do if you were in someone else's situation. It is particularly useful if you want to discuss a complicated technical problem.

If you write an article about solving issues, you can use modals like *would*, *should* or *could* to suggest solutions and offer assistance.

I would ...

I wouldn't ...

You could ...

You can also use *must*, *might want to* or Imperatives to strongly suggest a solution.

You might want to ...

You must ...

Always check ...

These are examples of Sally giving suggestions about how to deal with technical problems.

Examples:

- *You must make sure that you check both the date of publication and the date of the last revision.*
- *For this reason, you should always cross-check the information found online.*
- *You could also test the website's usability.*
- *You might want to start by browsing the site.*
- *You wouldn't want to waste your time on useless info!*





Learning Points

Talking About the Future

You can use four different tenses to talk about the future.

- When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future, you use the modal *will*.
- When you ask about intentions, you use *going to*.
- When you talk about things that are arranged, on the agenda or booked for the future, you use the Present Continuous tense.
- When you talk about schedules or timetables in the future, you use the Simple Present tense.

Verb Tense	Example
Future Tense (Will)	<i>You won't have enough information on just one website for all your needs.</i>
Going to	<i>Old literary texts or philosophical works aren't going to change much in the future.</i>
Present Continuous Tense	<i>The next time you're doing research online, check the accuracy of the information.</i>
Simple Present Tense	<i>We expect the new generation of browsers to do that for us from next year onwards.</i>

